

TV SHOW

Lucifer S5

★★★★☆ | The devil has finally returned with a 5th season. After Netflix revived the series for its 4th season, people were still doubtful, but Netflix actually knocked it out of the park with the 4th season. Naturally, the expectations were high. Thankfully, the 5th season has actually turned out to be pretty good, so far that is. Netflix has decided to split the season into two halves, with eight episodes already released, and eight more releasing at a later date. The devious folk that they are,



they found the biggest cliffhanger they could to end on with the eighth episode. At least they know for sure

we'll be back for episode nine. Overall, we think season 4 was still better than season 5 thus far, but only by a rather small margin.

The story continues where season 4 left off, with Lucifer back in hell, playing jailkeeper. On Earth, Amenadiel is learning to deal with being the father of a potentially celestial baby and everyone else is trying to fill the void left by Lucifer. All of that probably sounded extremely weird to anyone who's never watched the show...

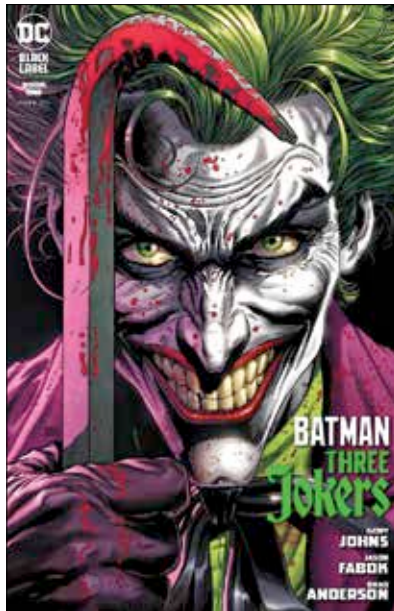
In season 5, there's a new angel in town and he looks suspiciously similar to Lucifer. You'll have to watch to find out if he's up to any good or not. The ending of episode eight definitely took us by surprise, we're looking forward to the next eight episodes.

COMIC

Batman: Three Jokers #1

★★★★☆ | This one is kind of like a spiritual sequel *Batman: The Killing Joke*, the seminal comic which is considered to be one of the best comics of all time. The writer team comprises of NYT bestselling author Geoff Johns and artist Jason Fabok who were together responsible for the Dark-seid War. Right off the bat, you know this is something special considering the subtle curve of the sickle in The Joker's hand, which is enough to convey his craziness.

Over the years, the Batman comics tend to ask a lot of crazy questions, like what if Batman was a medieval knight and the Joker was a dragon? Or, what if Batman died in the alley and Thomas Wayne became the Batman, while Martha Wayne became the Joker? This comic asks the question, what if there were three Jokers? What we get are three aspects of the Joker that are each explored to



their fullest extent, the criminal, the comedian and the clown. The panels are cinematic, and laid out like a storyboard, reminiscent of the style of *Watchmen*. The story follows all the landmark moments in the long history of the caped crusader, such as the time when Bane broke his back, or the moment Martha Wayne's pearl necklace broke.

There is plenty of meta commentary going on where in universe characters talk about the implications

of masked vigilantes. Of course there are a lot of over the top ridiculous crimes, and the story races along in a suitably chaotic manner, considering that there are three Jokers. There is a deliciously evil plan at play, and subtle hints about the origin of the Jokers, which are almost like easter eggs for those who have been reading the comics so far.

Fortunately, Batman has suitable company to take on the threat, with Batgirl and Robin (or the Red Hood) both joining the fight. All of them are however pushed by the machinations of the Jokers to places that they would rather not go. The comic also brings together different elements from various time periods, for example the cowl is from the Nolan's trilogy, the rest of the costume from the classic live action TV show, while the Batmobile is from Keaton's portrayal in *Batman Forever*. They all come together surprisingly well, especially considering the dark tone of the comic. All of this can be considered fan service, but it is well done and fits the story and what this comic is about so well. Ultimately *Three Jokers* explores the most explosive relationship at the heart of the Batman Mythos, and as such is a must read for comic book fans.